

The Morning Newspaper

TUESDAY, OCTOBER 6, 2026 · AUSTIN EDITION

89° / 67°

Clear, 1% rain, wind 8 mph

Tomorrow: 89° / 65°, clear

Sunrise 7:27 · Sunset 19:10

Waning crescent

Nobel Prize in Medicine Honors the Trio Who Taught Us to Flip Neurons Like Light Switches

Karl Deisseroth, Georg Nagel and Peter Hegemann share the 2026 prize for optogenetics, the technique that lets researchers turn individual brain cells on and off with pulses of light. The method, built from light-sensitive proteins borrowed from algae, now underpins thousands of neuroscience labs worldwide.

WORLD & TECH

Nvidia Nears \$6 Trillion as the AI Buildout Keeps Rolling

REUTERS · YAHOO FINANCE

Nvidia stock touched a fresh all-time high this week, pushing its market capitalization toward \$6 trillion and making it the most valuable public company on earth. Analysts point to sustained demand for AI data-center chips and the company's newly announced \$150 billion buyback as the drivers behind the rally. Some see the run as overdue vindication; others warn the AI trade is getting crowded.

White House Orders Agencies to Retire the Word "AI"

TECHCRUNCH · WHITE HOUSE

President Trump signed an executive order directing federal agencies to swap "artificial intelligence" for "Super Intelligence" in official communications, and unveiled a new Super Intelligence Force to coordinate policy. Tech companies signed a parallel industry agreement at the same event. The order gives a federal panel 60 days to propose a legal definition of the rebranded term.

OpenAI and TikTok Push Further Into Everyday AI

REUTERS

OpenAI said it will begin watermarking ChatGPT-generated text for users in the European Union,

aiming to ease regulators' concerns about AI-written content. TikTok, meanwhile, rolled out an AI shopping assistant with one-click checkout for US users. Both moves reflect a broader push to make AI tools feel more routine, and more accountable, in daily life.

MARKETS

INDEX	LAST	CHG
S&P 500	7,833.24	+0.76%
Dow Jones	51,639.35	+0.72%
Nasdaq	27,683.04	+0.75%
Russell 2000	2,852.82	+0.20%
VIX	15.41	-0.71%
10-yr yield	5.30	-0.19%

CRYPTO

Bitcoin	\$86,195	-0.45%
Ethereum	\$2,711.50	-0.55%

STOCKS

NVDA	\$242.00	+1.30%
AAPL	\$332.97	+0.02%
MSFT	\$533.60	+1.60%
GOOGL	\$345.98	-0.14%
AMZN	\$253.07	+0.66%
META	\$740.27	-0.22%
AVGO	\$376.42	+3.84%
TSLA	\$381.22	+0.66%
SPCX	\$175.12	+2.35%
BRK-B	\$508.07	+0.76%
TSM	\$484.00	-0.37%

Stocks drifted higher again, with the Nasdaq setting a fresh record as AI-linked names led the charge. Broadcom jumped nearly 4% on booming demand for its custom AI chips, while Nvidia pushed toward a \$6 trillion valuation on the strength of its data-center buildout and a freshly announced buyback. Bond yields eased slightly even as the VIX ticked down, suggesting traders are shrugging off rate worries for now. Bitcoin and Ethereum slipped modestly, a rare quiet day for crypto amid the equity rally.

ON THIS DAY

1927: The Jazz Singer, the first feature film with synchronized dialogue, opens in New York, ushering in the era of talking pictures.

FROM THE FEEDS · FULL TEXT IN SECTION B

AEON

How to assemble science — makes sense of a flood of new research most of us never see.

LONGREADS

The Eels Were Climbing Out of the Water to Die — a mass fish kill in England traces back to ordinary runoff pollution.

LONGREADS

The Bizarre, Murky History of Soviet-Born Tetris — the world's favorite puzzle game has a tangled ownership story few tell straight.

LONGREADS

The Unforeseen Something — a rare disease diagnosis in an Iowa family turned into a medical breakthrough.

NAUTILUS

Thousands of Fancy Dishes Have Survived a 2,100-Year-Old Shipwreck — ancient tableware outlasted the ship, crew and empire that made it.

NAUTILUS

David Byrne Awakens the Story of Dark Matter — the musician's new book revisits Vera Rubin's overlooked astronomy.

PSYCHE

A psychological guide to climbing out of debt — a therapist argues debt is an emotional problem first, a financial one second.

TRICYCLE

The Buddha of the Future — a scholar argues Maitreya is closer to our world than tradition suggests.

LONGREADS

The Unforeseen Something

LONGREADS · LONGREADS.COM · OCT 6, 2026

A rare disease diagnosis in an Iowa family becomes a story of community and medical discovery.

Mark Johnson | The Atavist Magazine | September 2026 | 2,048 words (7 minutes)

This is an excerpt from issue no. 180, “The Family Plan.”

At first she told no one. Not her twin sister. Not her mother. Not even her father the scientist.

Six-year-old Jenna Smith knew better than to pee when she was in the bath. But on that night in 1992, in her family’s home in Iowa City, the water felt so comfortable against her skin that she didn’t want to get out of the tub. It seemed like such a small thing. Who would know?

Seconds later the water around her waist turned reddish pink. Blood? It had to be. Jenna wondered if she’d hurt herself. “I was six years

old sitting in a bathtub, watching a few seconds of my world stop making sense,” she would recall years later.

She kept the blood a secret because she didn’t want to admit that she’d peed in the bath. But when it was still in her urine the next time she used the toilet, she went to her mother. Concerned, her mom called her dad, Richard Smith, and he took Jenna to the emergency room.

Richard was an ear, nose, and throat doctor in the University of Iowa’s school of medicine, a researcher who would become one of the world’s authorities on the genetics of hearing loss. His wife, Lynne Lanning, had worked as both a lawyer and a nurse. They had four young children: twins Jenna and Jessica, who were identical, and two boys, Luke and Rion.



Continued online (full article about 2073 words). Scan, or visit <https://longreads.com/2026/10/06/rare-disease-c3g-iowa/>

LONGREADS

'The Eels Were Climbing Out of the Water to Die': Why Did Every Fish in This Idyllic Lake Perish Overnight?

CAROLYN WELLS · LONGREADS.COM · OCT 6, 2026

A mass fish kill in an English brook traces back to an all-too-common culprit.

Steve Rose investigates a catastrophic pollution incident at Furnace Brook, a fishing lake in East Sussex, where thousands of fish suddenly died and the local ecosystem collapsed. Neighbours suspect pollution from nearby Morgans Farm, and Rose examines whether their concerns are justified. In doing so, he uncovers broader national problems with water pollution, illegal waste dumping, and the limited power and resources councils and regulators have to tackle them.

He headed about half a mile up the valley to a tributary joining the stream from a neighbouring property named Morgans Farm. “You

could clearly see the water upstream [of the tributary] was totally normal, a sandy colour with clay silt in it, and what was below it had gone a blue-black colour. You could see dead brook trout, wild eels, and there was a dead crow or raven, which may well have eaten something poisonous from the river.” In some places, he says, there was a thick layer of blue-grey scum on the water, which he later learned is sometimes called “bacterial cheese”. “There’s so much nutrient [sic] in the water that it allows for a bacterial colonisation explosion.” The bacteria take up all the oxygen, which causes most of the fish, especially the older, larger ones, to die.

LONGREADS

The Bizarre, Murky History of Soviet-Born Tetris

CHERI LUCAS ROWLANDS · LONGREADS.COM · OCT 6, 2026

The real, tangled origin story behind the world's most famous puzzle game.

The beloved video game Tetris has a fascinating, complicated history. While the Tetris Company (TTC) claims exclusive rights to the geometric pieces at the heart of the game, known as tetrominoes, history shows that the Russian engineer and game designer duo behind TTC did not, in fact, own them. In this excerpt

of Soviet Blocks: The Bizarre Puzzle of How Tetris Embraced Western Values, Julien Mailland traces Tetris’s journey from the Soviet Union to the West, and shows how the game is a lens through which to view two very different systems.

After the Soviet Union collapsed, Belikov and Patjinov — who by then had teamed up with Nintendo’s fixer Henk Rogers — sued each other over the rights to the game in federal court in New York. Pajitnov had very little going for him. The USSR did not recognize

software copyright, or any private property for that matter other than for household pots and pans. Further, he developed the game on his work computer during work hours, which under U.S. legal principles would make it his employer’s property.

AEON

How to assemble science

HELEN PEARSON · AEON.CO · OCT 6, 2026

A case for making sense of the staggering volume of research we produce but rarely digest.

When reading the news, you may occasionally be bemused by the flip-flopping science and health stories: one week you’re told coffee is good for you, the next week that it’s bad. Red wine extends your life, then it doesn’t. Over time, new scientific studies seemingly contradict one another, leaving us unsure what evidence to believe.

As a science journalist, I’ve learnt that often the actual problem is that each study is reported in isolation, rather than weighed against everything else we know. And sometimes, the risks of harm are high. For example, in September 2025, I reported on the US Food and Drug Administration’s announcement that it would add a warning label to the painkiller acetaminophen (paracetamol), claiming that taking the drug during pregnancy increased a child’s risk of autism. It made global headlines. Yet looking closer at the science, it was clear

that the FDA and its parent health department had cherry-picked a few studies, and downplayed other more robust findings. This was confirmed a couple of months later when researchers published a major review that better represented the full body of knowledge. ‘Existing evidence does not clearly link maternal paracetamol use during pregnancy with autism or ADHD in offspring,’ it concluded. By then, of course, countless women had been needlessly scared about a painkiller that is widely considered one of the safest to take during pregnancy.

In 2025, academics worldwide published about 7 million scholarly articles – that’s more than 19,000 each day. On the surface, that might seem like a number to celebrate, but it also poses a problem. As the volume of research balloons, it can be hard to discern what these millions of papers actually tell us.



Continued online (full article about 3529 words). Scan, or visit <https://aeon.co/essays/the-life-saving-scientific-knowledge-hiding-in-pla-in-sight>

NAUTILUS

David Byrne Awakens the Story of Dark Matter

DAVID BYRNE · NAUTILUS.US · OCT 6, 2026

The musician's new book revisits Vera Rubin's underappreciated astronomy.

In 1986, I got invited to show a film at the Rio Film Festival. It was my first time in Brazil, and though I was familiar with some of the better-known musical artists there, I quickly realized there were many more I’d never heard of. A local music fan offered to take me to a record store in Rio, and I left the store with an armload of vinyl. One of the records I picked up had the word “samba” on the cover and, oddly, an image of barbed wire. Many of the other samba records had pictures of girls in bikinis on the cover or a smiling singer, so this one, I imagined, might be different. The artist was someone named Tom Zé.

As my purchases were all vinyl, I had no idea what they sounded like until I returned to NYC about a week later. Upon listening, I discovered that many of the records were beautiful and important,

and I still listen to them today, but it was the Tom Zé record that was a revelation. His music was the kind of experimentation familiar to the downtown NY music scene that I was accustomed to, but with a Brazilian vibe. I’d never heard anything like this—radical boundary-pushing music was happening there too? (I wondered from my NY-centric point of view.)

I played the record for my business partner Yale Evelev at Luaka Bop, the record label I founded, and he was as surprised as I was. By that time, we’d released three compilations of popular Brazilian music that had been well received, and we thought, “Let’s show them that there’s another side to Brazilian music.” We decided to put out a compilation culled from Zé recordings.



Continued online (full article about 2078 words). Scan, or visit <https://nautil.us/david-byrne-awakens-the-story-of-dark-matter-1285530/>